

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

State agrees to pay \$1.3M for never-built shelter

Gov. Pritzker assured that taxpayers wouldn't pay for tent encampment for migrants

By Dan Petrella
Chicago Tribune

Despite assurances from Gov. JB Pritzker that state taxpayers would not end up footing the bill for a migrant tent encampment in Chicago that was never built, the state recently agreed to pay \$1.3 million to the project's contractor. Pritzker made the highly publicized decision to halt construc-

tion of the shelter encampment in Chicago's Brighton Park neighborhood in December 2023, saying "serious environmental concerns" were still present at the city-selected site. The governor's decision caused the Brighton Park project to be scrapped, and it signaled an early political rift between the governor and Mayor Brandon Johnson, who was pushing for the shelter to be built as winter arrived and the

migrant crisis in the city continued. Pritzker that month also made public assurances that the project's state contractor, GardaWorld Federal Services, would absorb the costs of the work that it had already put into constructing the camp. "The understanding with GardaWorld is that they will do other work with us," Pritzker told reporters at an unrelated event in December 2023. "And they knew, as they were building this shelter, before the environmental report

Turn to Shelter, Page 4



Signs proclaiming environmental hazards are posted at the tent encampment for migrants in the Brighton Park neighborhood on Nov. 29, 2023. E.JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE



Union members and supporters rally in Grand Park in Los Angeles on Monday calling for the release of union leader David Huerta.

President orders 700 Marines to Los Angeles

California to sue Trump over use of Guard amid protests

By Jason Dearen and Tim Sullivan
Associated Press

LOS ANGELES — The Pentagon planned to deploy about 700 Marines to Los Angeles on Monday to help National Guard members respond to immigration protests, three U.S. officials said as California prepared to sue President Donald Trump over his use of Guard troops to confront the protesters.

The Marines were to be deployed from their base at Twentynine Palms in the Southern California desert. The officials spoke on condition of anonymity to discuss military plans. The deployment was first reported by CNN. The attorney general said the president's actions had "trampled" the state's sovereignty. "We don't take lightly to the president abusing his authority and unlawfully mobilizing California National Guard troops," state Attorney General Rob Bonta told reporters. He planned to seek a court order declaring Trump's use of the National Guard was unlaw-

Turn to Marines, Page 8



A protester stands on a car near other burning vehicles on Sunday in Los Angeles. MARIO TAMA/GETTY PHOTOS

Not your gramp's City Council

Chicago aldermen less aligned with 5th floor

By Jake Sheridan
Chicago Tribune

When Ald. Scott Waguespack started his City Council career as an opponent of Mayor Richard M. Daley, it was mostly at the wrong end of a bunch of lopsided votes.

But his days as one of five aldermen who said no to Daley's infamous parking meter deal or a quixotic early thorn to Mayor Rahm Emanuel are long gone. Now, when the Northwest Side alderman butts heads with Mayor Brandon Johnson, he is often one of many across a relatively broad political spectrum, and sometimes he even gets his way.

"You see more accountability and more responsibility that's shared now than in the past," he said. "I think you're seeing people kind of trust in each other."

It's a sea change that grew under Mayor Lori Lightfoot, and is gaining momentum in City Hall with Johnson: The City Council, long derided as a mayoral puppet, is increasingly operating independent of the fifth floor.

The shift follows the demise of Chicago's infamous machine politics. It also tracks with the ascension of the aldermanic Progressive Caucus and the "Common Sense Caucus" formed in part to oppose it, both shifting groups that bring more ideological force into debates.

As the City Council changes, some aldermen lament a decline in decorum and a heightened willingness to impede opponents by any means as harmful to progress. But others view the growing pains as a worthwhile price for what they hope will become permanent independence.

"Under Lightfoot we were

Turn to Aldermen, Page 2

Judge denies Michael Madigan's motion for new trial

A federal judge on Monday denied a motion by former House Speaker Michael Madigan seeking to overturn his recent conviction on bribery and other corruption counts, setting the stage for a high-stakes sentencing hearing later this week.

Chicagoland, Page 3

Official in mayor's office leaving for Obama Foundation

Roberson is last of Johnson's inner circle with previous City Hall experience

By Jake Sheridan, Alice Yin and A.D. Quig
Chicago Tribune

Mayor Brandon Johnson's chief operating officer is leaving the administration to join the Obama Foundation, ending weeks of speculation — and push-

back — over his potential appointment to lead the CTA.

The Obama Foundation told the Tribune that John Roberson will join its leadership team as executive vice president starting July 7. And Johnson spokesperson Cassio Mendoza confirmed Roberson's last day in the mayor's

office will be June 20.

"I want to thank John Roberson for his dedication and service to our city over these past two years," Johnson said in a statement. "I wish him the best of luck as he continues to serve our city in his new role at the Obama Foundation."

Roberson did not immediately respond to a request for comment Monday.

A member of the administration since the freshman mayor assumed office, Roberson is the last official within Johnson's inner circle with previous City Hall experience. His resignation

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TODAY'S WEATHER



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Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 14

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Illustration by Anita Kunz